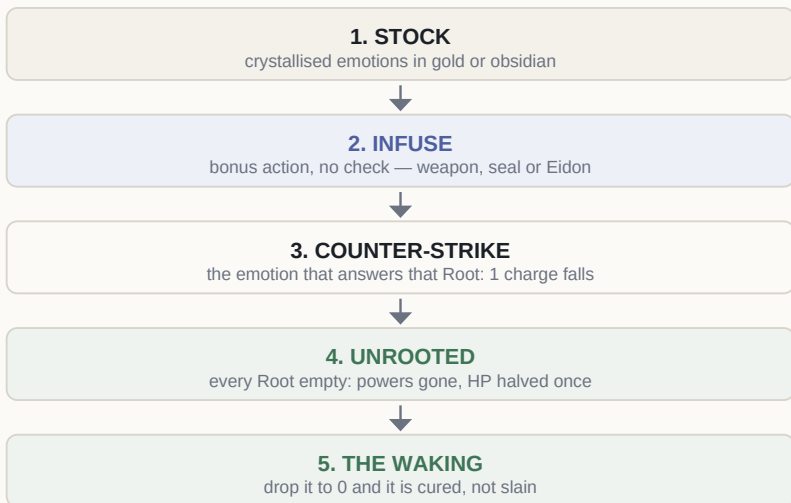


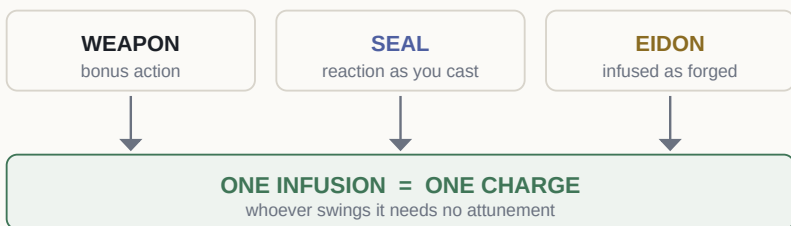
Purification at the Table

Three worked fights with the Cognition of Emotion — seals, Eidons, and the day the vessels were empty.



The loop, start to finish. Nothing else in the system matters until these five are familiar.

Three ways to carry it



Ignition users can never learn Arcanum Veritas — this is how they purify.

An infusion rides **one** delivery. An Area seal that catches four Nightmares still strips **one** charge — the limits are per Root and per creature, never per target.

The quick card

	Rule
Infuse	Bonus action, no check. One stored emotion. Lasts 10 min, spent only when it purifies. PB per long rest.

	Rule
Strip	Hit with the countering Virtuous emotion: 1 charge. 2 on a crit or a Pure infusion.
Limits	One charge per creature per round. One charge per Root per round.
Lash Out	First charge lost each round: it answers whoever stripped it. Once per round <i>per Nightmare</i> .
Resist	LR negates a charge, once per Root — and still uses that Root's slot.
Charges	Demi 1 · Standard 2 · Named 3 · Primal 5 , per Root.
Unrooted	Vile powers and LRs gone, can't heal, current HP halved once.
Cure	Drop it to 0 while Unrooted. Then The Waking — see the last page.

The party (level 9, PB +4)

Who	System	Brings
Nera	Arcanum Veritas	Emotion , Life. Verum Mod +5, Dream +1, DC 18 . The only one who can make an infusion.
Ivo	Arcanum Veritas	Sadness, Joy — two Primals, so he harvests a Core once per seal, free.
Bram	Ignitions	Burns Fear / Anger . 4 Blaze, 6d12 pool. Eidons count as 2nd-level slots.
Kess	Ignitions	Burns Joy / Speed . 4 Blaze. Bind and Strike Templates.

Why this party. A character who knows Arcanum Veritas can never learn Ignitions, so Bram and Kess will never cast a seal — but they carry Nera's infusions into Eidons and purify exactly as well as she does. **Stock:** 2 Hope · 2 Friendship · 1 Belonging · 1 Justice.

Fight One — four Standard Nightmares

Each is **2 Roots x 2 charges**. Curing all four is 16 charges — more than a day's stock. **Cure the one that was a person; kill the rest.**

	Nightmare	Roots	Counters
N1	The Weeping Teacher (<i>was a person</i>)	Despair, Loneliness	Hope, Belonging
N2	Gnash	Hate, Anxiety	Friendship, Courage
N3	The Red Debt	Revenge, Anxiety	Justice, Courage
N4	Hollow Sister	Apathy, Despair	Love, Hope

Round 1

SEAL Ivo — Sadness, Offensive / Area, 3rd slot, into N2 and N3. Cold damage, speeds halved. **Primal Harvest** fills a coin with Sadness on the way past — free, no check.

SEAL Nera — **Virtuous Infusion**, Supportive / Ally, spending **Hope**, onto **Bram and Kess**. Their strikes now carry Hope for 10 minutes. *Costs them nothing.*

EIDON Bram — burns **Fear**, spends 1 Blaze, forges a **Strike** Eidon: 6d12 pool, 2 dice spent on reach and a rider, check DC 8 — 14, manifested. It lands on N1 **carrying Hope against Despair: 1 charge off.**

LASH OUT — N1 answers Bram: 12 damage. Once this round, whatever else falls.

Kess — Despair is closed for the round, so she Binds N4 instead and saves her Hope.

N1 — Despair 1/2 · Loneliness 2/2

Round 2

EIDON Kess — Strike Eidon as a **Bonus Action** (half output, still purifies) with her Hope: **Despair nullified**. Lash Out turns on her.

SEAL Nera — second seal, spending **Belonging**, onto Bram and Ivo.

SEAL Ivo — Joy seal on the wounded; harvests a **Joy Core**.

Rounds 3 and 4

Bram and Ivo take Loneliness down one charge each — one per creature, one per Root, so it takes both of them and two rounds.

UNROOTED — N1 loses her Vile powers, can't heal, and her 41 HP halves to 20. On her turn she does not attack. She says a name.

SEAL Ivo — Offensive seal with **Spell Infusion** finishes her at range. **Cured**. He knew her; he says her name aloud as the last charge falls.

Cost: two crystallised emotions, **zero** personal infusion uses, one Blaze each from Bram and Kess, four rounds. N2–N4 died the ordinary way alongside.

Why a bigger party is not a faster one

	Root A	Root B	Root C
Bram	1 charge	—	—
Kess	—	1 charge	—
Ivo	—	—	1 charge
Nera	—	—	—

Nera seals instead of striking. Kess and Ivo take the other Roots; nobody doubles up.

Four people, three Roots, one round. Everyone who strikes lands exactly one charge, and no Root takes two. More friends means **more Roots at once**, never a Root falling faster.

Fight Two — the Primal

The Mother of Locked Doors. Pure Roots **Loneliness, Despair, Shame** (Belonging, Hope, Self-Respect), **5 charges each**, 3 Legendary Resistances, four adds. That is 15 charges plus up to 3 resisted: **18 strikes, at 3 a round.**

Round	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Loneliness		LR	1	1	1	1	1		
Despair			1	1	1	1	1		
Shame					LR	1	1	2	1

1 = a charge stripped · LR = Legendary Resistance (and the Root's slot is spent)

UNROOTED

How it actually ran. Rounds 1–2 are setup and a wasted Resistance; from round 3 the party works all three Roots in parallel, which is the only way the maths closes.

KEY MOVE — split your targets. A new infusion replaces the old one, so Nera seals **Belonging on Bram and Kess**, then **Hope on Ivo and herself**, never the whole party at once. One emotion on everybody is three-quarters wasted.

EIDON Blaze runs out. Bram has 4 Blaze and this fight is nine rounds. From round 5 he stops forging and simply swings an infused blade — a weapon strips a charge exactly as an Eidon does.

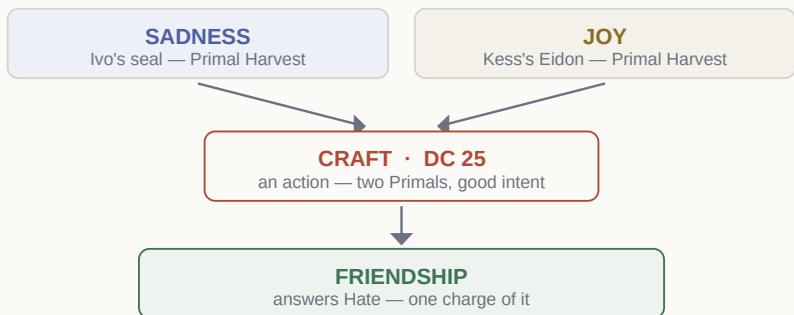
Round 3, the turn that decides it. Nera spends her action on Emotion Identification: the third Root is **Shame**, and nobody has crafted Self-Respect. Kess makes it under fire on round 5.

Total: about seven crystallised emotions through seals, three hand-infusions, eight Blaze between two Ignition users, nine rounds. A Primal was never a person: she vanishes.

Fight Three — empty vessels

No stock. Nothing crystallised, nothing stored. One **Demi Nightmare** (Root: **Hate**, 1 charge) and two Standards. Can they still cure anything?

Yes — but only the shallowest thing on the field, and only by making the emotion in the middle of the fight.



Two Primals harvested free by the people already fighting, fused under fire.

Rounds 1–2 — harvest

SEAL Ivo — Sadness seal: **Primal Harvest**, one Sadness in a coin. The Primals pay for themselves — no check, no attunement to Emotion needed.

EIDON Kess — Joy Eidon: her burning Cognition's mastery applies to an Eidon exactly as to a seal, so she harvests a **Joy**.

Nera now holds Sadness + Joy — the recipe for Friendship, which answers Hate.

Round 3 — the gamble

Nera — Craft as an action. Friendship is a two-Primal emotion, **DC 25**; at level 5+ she ignores the +5 for working in combat. She rolls $9 + 7 = 16$. **Failed by 9** — failure by 5 or more **destroys both Cores**. Two rounds of harvest, gone.

Rounds 4–6 — again, properly

Ivo harvests another Sadness; Kess another Joy. This time **Ivo's Joy seal hands Nera Inspiration** first.

Nera — Craft with advantage: $19 + 7 = 26$. **Friendship crystallised**. One coin, one emotion, one charge's worth.

SEAL Nera — Virtuous Infusion, spending it onto Bram.

Round 7 — one charge is all it takes

EIDON Bram — Fear Eidon carrying Friendship into the Demi's single Hate Root. **UNROOTED** on the first charge: a Demi holds only one.

Kess — finishes it. **Cured**.

What zero stock costs: seven rounds, one destroyed harvest, and you cure the **Demi** — never the Standards, whose four charges would need four crafts. The two Standards die the ordinary way. **This is the fight that teaches why downtime crafting is the campaign loop.**

Optional dial — Battlefield Craft. If that feels too punishing, let a Craft that uses Cores harvested *this combat* drop its DC by 5: fresh-drawn emotion is easier to work than stored. Friendship becomes DC 20, and the scene above lands on the first attempt.

The Waking

Cured is not restored. When a Nightmare drops to 0 while Unrooted it is freed — but what walks out of the dream is not always who walked in. Most of the time it is one of the first two.

Outcome	When
It vanishes peacefully	The default. The torment ends and what was borrowed goes back to the Night.
It stays as a guardian	If it was born of the dream rather than made from a person — or if someone offers it a purpose in the moment of the cure.
It reclaims who it was	Possible, never automatic. All three must hold: there is something to return to; someone present knew them and names them aloud as the last charge falls; and the freeing strike carried the emotion countering their first Root.

When all three hold, the freed dreamer makes a **Dream saving throw** against the Nightmare's own DC.

Success — they wake as themselves. They remember being the Nightmare, and everything it did, and they will carry that. But they are them.

Failure — they wake, alive, but something did not come back: a memory, a face they should know, a skill, a year. The table decides what is missing. It does not return on its own.

A Primal Nightmare was never a person and cannot reclaim an identity it never had. It may only vanish, or be bound as a guardian — and binding one is a story in itself.

What the three fights teach

- 1. Seal, don't hand-infuse.** One emotion through Nera's seal arms two or three people and costs them nothing. Hand-infusion is for plugging a gap.
- 2. Split your targets.** A new infusion replaces the old, and a Root takes one charge a round.
- 3. Every system purifies.** Weapon, seal and Eidon all carry an infusion. Only *making* one needs the Cognition of Emotion.
- 4. Watch the Blaze, not just the stock.** An Ignition user has PB Eidons in them. In a nine-round fight they finish it with an ordinary infused blade.
- 5. Charges scale, so pick your target.** A Demi is one charge. A Standard is four. A Primal is fifteen. Cure what the story needs cured.
- 6. Empty vessels means Primals.** With no stock, the Cognitions that harvest for free are the whole engine — and you are gambling two rounds of harvest on one Craft.

Once Upon a Star · Magic System / Emotion · worked example for Emotion Infuse, Nightmare Purification and The Waking